

MICROSOFT INTERVIEW EXPERIENCE

Microsoft Corporation is an American multinational corporation and technology company headquartered in Redmond, Washington.[2] Its best-known software products are the Windows line of operating systems, the Microsoft 365 suite of productivity applications, the Azure cloud computing platform and the Edge web browser. Its flagship hardware products are the Xbox video game consoles and the Microsoft Surface lineup of touchscreen personal computers.

Role Offered: Software Engineer

Stipend: 1,25,000 INR per month

Sequence of Selection: Online Test, Technical Interview 1, Technical Interview 2 (Completely Virtual)

Online Test:

It consisted of two problems.

First Problem:

Given two very long numbers in a linked list, how many swaps do you need to make the absolute difference between the number's minimum.

You can only swap corresponding indices. That is $A[i1]$ can only be swapped with $B[i2]$.

Example Test Case:

$A = "9\ 8\ 6\ 5"$

$B = "2\ 3\ 4\ 5"$

Output: 1;

Explanation: We can swap 8 with 3 and 6 with 4 and the answer would be 2 swaps with a minimum value of 6480 (9345-2865). But this is not the minimum. The minimum is swap is 1 because 9345-2865 is also 6480.

Second Problem:

Then the first question the interviewer asked me was that if I was familiar with linked lists. I answered Yes.

He asked me the question, that I have to delete any nodes that has than more than one occurrence. The given list was also sorted. So, for example, if the given list was 1->2->2->3, the result should be 1->3. The deletion should be in-place. So, the head should be returned.

I was able to talk to him and also come up with a working solution.

Then we moved on to the next question. The question was to print all the prime numbers until 500. I used Sieve of Eratosthenes algorithm to come up with an efficient solution.

Takeaway:

In my opinion, the questions were easy. The critical factor in the interview was the way you solve it.

Your approach only matters. If you can talk and do the solution parallelly, it shows the interviewer your thinking process. So, be sure to talk during the interview.

Technical Interview 2:

3 hours later (Same day)

The same initial setup with sharing my screen with my camera.

The interviewer first asked me not to be nervous and asked me to explain my thought at each step. Then the question asked to me was <https://leetcode.com/problems/restore-ip-addresses/description/> . I never solved this question at leetcode but I was able to come up with a solution during the interview. I coded the entire solution in notepad.

The interview lasted for an hour.

Takeaway:

As I said talking out your solution is what matters the most. The solution I came up with was not very efficient at all but I still explain my though process.

Conclusion:

After 2.5 hours (Same day)

I got the message that I was selected for their internship. (Completely over the moon).

Always try to explain your thoughts. The interviewer helps you to come to the right solution. Don't panic, stay calm and try to code your answer.

All the very best.

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